title, the Coolidge Cricket Ground, but is known locally as ‘Sticky Wicket Stadium’.

That’s appropriate, all things considered. Stanford was a bizarre figure who didn’t endear himself by posing for photographs with Matty Prior’s pregnant wife on his lap. My first impression of him was as someone who wanted fame as well as fortune.

It was sad, because it had the potential to splinter the squad. Each player on the winning side was due to earn £500,000. The ECB and West Indies Cricket Board took £3.5 million, with a further £1 million divided between the winning coach and the rest of the squad. That’s obviously a lot of money for carrying drinks; as it turned out, Jimmy Anderson and I watched our innings from a swimming pool overlooking the ground, after training earlier in the day.

We didn’t pick a specialist T20 squad and went with the one-day group that was due to go on to India. We made 99. Chris Gayle and Andre Fletcher, their opening pair, knocked off the runs in 12.4 overs. The local lads were beside themselves; they spoke of the cars and houses they would buy. The bubble burst quickly, but according to Tony Cozier, only one of them lost their money by ploughing it back into Stanford’s crooked investment scheme.

Times have changed. Virat Kohli picked up £2 million for captaining Royal Challengers Bangalore in the 2019 IPL, while Ben Stokes was the highest paid foreign player, collecting £1.5 million for six weeks’ work with Rajasthan Royals. Stanford’s fleeting success owed a lot to his ability to play on the inferiority complex created by historic underpayment of cricket’s best players.

Sportsmen who come from disadvantaged economic backgrounds are inevitably vulnerable to exploitation. Unfortunately, we see that, to an extent, in match fixing, especially on the subcontinent, where, by accepting as little as $100 from a corrupt bookmaker or gambler, a young player, very early in his career, can essentially sell his soul inadvertently. He is trapped, susceptible to blackmail, for the rest of his career.

The immediate motivation is understandable, since very few fledgling players make it. In a world without guarantees the chance of feeding the family for three months with that $100 is attractive. But if things go well, and his talent blossoms over two to four critical years of development into